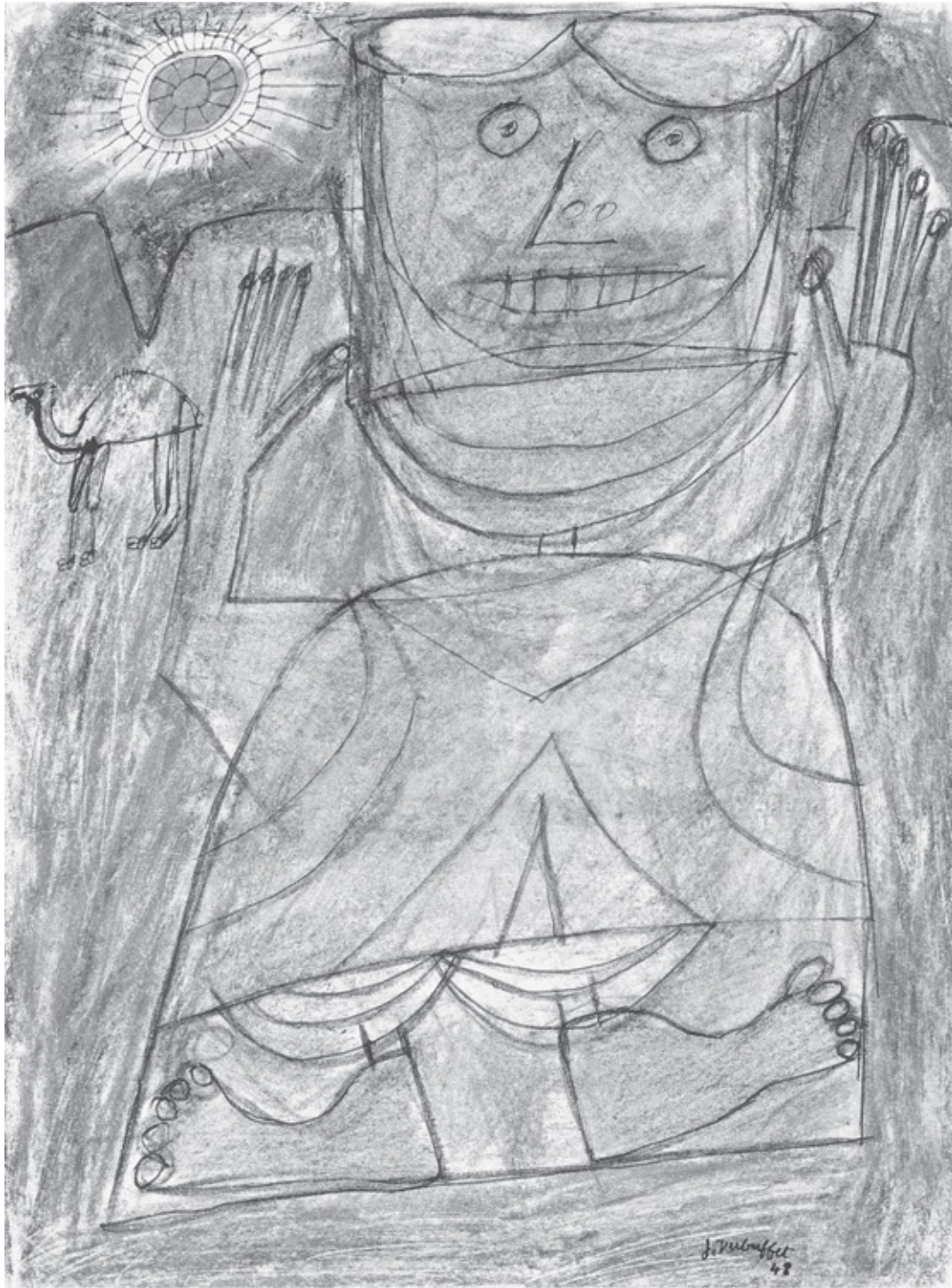


# Art Brut and CoBrA

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Invented by the French artist Jean Dubuffet (1901–85), Art Brut (Raw or Crude Art) describes a type of graffiti or naïve art created from 1945. Inspired by the art of the insane, prisoners, children and primitive artists, Dubuffet believed that artists were suppressed by academic training, and incorporated unrestrained, unrefined qualities into his own art. He covered canvases with glue, sand and resin, painted over them and scratched the surface with arbitrary symbols.

In 1948, artists from Copenhagen (Co), Brussels (Br) and Amsterdam (A) formed CoBrA, an avant-garde movement that opposed Surrealism and instead used lines, colours and forms freely. Members including Karel Appel (1921–2006), Corneille (1922–2010), Christian Dotremont (1922–79), Asger Jorn (1914–73) and Joseph Noiret (1927–2012) signed a manifesto, *La Cause Était Entendue* ('The Case Was Settled'). Although a group, each artist experimented and worked spontaneously, drawing inspiration from Klee, Miró, children's drawings and primitive art.



Dubuffet, *Bedouin, raised arms*, 1948